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7.XII.21

TELEGRAMS. "AQUILÆ, LONDON"
TELEPHONE NOS REGENT 4024 & 4025.

ROYAL SOCIETIES CLUB,
ST. JAMES'S STREET,
S.W.

Dear Mr Russell,

I write to ask whether you could support me in applying for a Government loan for scientific investigation.

I am reading a paper on Probability to the Aristotelian Society which will be a summary of a book I hope to finish next year. I am trying to leave off where Keynes & other mathematicians start. If mathematics starts with 1 and ends by finding what is $= 0$, I, as a linguist, claim to start with 0 and end up somehow with what is $= 1$. I have worked through various statistical results of science that more or less illustrate the processes of language as I conceive them. But I am inclined to think that an original piece of statistical work composed specially for the purpose, would be more suitable as the practical illustration of my thesis. I begin working out what does not as yet "exist" (i.e. the 0) and show how it becomes 1; and I can think of no better field than North America where in a short time there will be a great economic divide, as Wade explained in his

lecture last night (1 enclosure cutting).

I am probably going to Mauritius for a short time later in 1922 to do the work mentioned in the enclosed letter. Now I have six months or so free & I should like to spend ~~the~~ ^{the time} constructing the Great Divide.

As regards the money, what I really want is official recognition: I can't afford to risk so much on a private venture. But it seems to me a sound "proposition", for I am almost certain to be able to get help from the U.S.A. and the Canadian Government - in fact I shall have to, if I am to do it properly - It is quite possible that a profit may be made. But I am ~~quite~~ willing to sacrifice £500 if necessary when I have done it. The difference may seem small, but it makes all the difference to me, as the £500 securities I offer to hand over are all I have.

In case you have forgotten me, I enclose a couple of testimonials.

Yours sincerely
W.O. Brizstocke.